INCH-POUND

MIL-S-44377
19 October 1989
SUPERSEDING
(see 6.6)

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

SNOWSHOE, TRAIL, MAGNESIUM, SNOW AND ICE TRAVERSING EQUIPMENT (SITE)

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type and size of snowshoe for travel over snow and ice covered terrain. The snowshoe shall be manufactured from magnesium alloy, corrosion resisting steel, cold roll steel and nylon covered carbon steel wire rope lacing.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Government documents.

2.1.1 Specifications, standards, and handbooks. The following specifications, standards, and handbooks form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of these documents are those listed in the issue of the Department of Defense Index of Specifications and Standards (DODISS) and supplement thereto, cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, Natick, MA 01760-5014 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

AMSC N/A FSC 8465

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SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

A-A-203 - Paper, Kraft, Untreated
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard

MILITARY

MIL-L-35078 - Loads, Unit: Preperation of Semiperishable Subsistence Items; Clothing, Personal Equipment and Equipage; General Specification For

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage
MIL-STD-147 - Palletized Unit Loads
MIL-STD-731 - Quality of Wood Members for Containers and Pallets

(Unless otherwise indicated, copies of federal and military specifications, standards, and handbooks are available from the Naval Publications and Forms Center, (ATTN: NPODS), 5801 Tabor Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19120-5099.)

2.1.2 Other Government documents, drawings, and publications. The following other Government documents, drawings, and publications form a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues are those cited in the solicitation.

DRAWINGS

U.S. ARMY NATICK RESEARCH, DEVELOPMENT, AND ENGINEERING CENTER

2-10-98 - Snowshoe, Trail, Magnesium; Assembly
2-10-99 - Snowshoe, Trail, Magnesium; Frame Assembly
2-10-106 - Connector

(Copies of drawings are available from the U.S. Army Natick Research, Development, and Engineering Center, ATTN: STRNC-EMSS, Natick, MA 01760-5014.)

2.2 Non-Government publications. The following document forms a part of this document to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of the documents which are DOD adopted are those listed in the issue of the DODISS cited in the solicitation. Unless otherwise specified, the issues of documents not listed in the DODISS are the issues of the documents cited in the solicitation (see 6.2).

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AMERICAN SOCIETY FOR TESTING AND MATERIALS (ASTM)

D 3951 - Standard Practice for Commercial Packaging

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103-1187.)

(Non-Government standards and other publications are normally available from the organizations that prepare or distribute the documents. These documents also may be available in or through libraries or other informational services.)

2.3 Order of precedence. In the event of a conflict between the text of this document and the references cited herein, the text of this document takes precedence. Nothing in this document, however, supersedes applicable laws and regulations unless a specific exemption has been obtained.

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 First article. When specified (see 6.2), a sample shall be subjected to first article inspection (see 6.3) in accordance with 4.3.

3.2 Guide samples. Guide samples, when furnished, are solely for guidance and information (see 6.4). Variations from this specification may appear in the sample, in which case this specification shall govern.

3.3 Materials. The materials shall be as specified on Drawing 2-10-98 and all subsidiary drawings and parts lists pertaining thereto. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirement of this specification.

3.4 Design and construction. The snowshoe design and construction shall conform to Drawing 2-10-98 and all subsidiary drawings and parts lists (PLS) pertaining thereto.

3.4.1 Lacing. The enamel shall be thoroughly dry before lacing the snowshoe. The snowshoe shall be laced by passing the cable specified on Drawing 2-10-98 through each lacing hole in the frame to form an interlaced web pattern similar to that partially shown on Drawing 2-10-98 and the lacing shall meet the requirements specified in 3.4.1.1 and 3.4.1.2. The ends of all lacing shall extend through to the ends of connectors or sleeves, and all lacing ends shall be enclosed by and secured with connectors or sleeves specified in 3.5 by crimping. Lacing ends shall not extend over 1/2 inch beyond the connector or sleeve end.

3.4.1.1 Toe and heel section lacing. The toe and heel sections shall each be laced with not more than two lengths of cable. The lacing in the toe and heel sections shall not deflect more than 1/4 inch under a 30-pound dead load when

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tested as specified in 4.4.5. After the load is removed, the lacings shall not have a permanent set greater than 1/32 inch. The minimum number of crossing cables running in each direction shall be as shown in figure 1.

3.4.1.2 Center section lacing. The center section shall be laced with not more than three lengths of cable. The lacing in the center section shall not deflect more than 1 inch under a 200-pound dead load when tested as specified in 4.4.5. After the load is removed, the lacing shall not have a permanent set greater than 1/8 inch.

3.5 Connectors. The connectors shall be fabricated of steel specified on Drawing 2-10-106 and shall be as shown on Drawing 2-10-106. Connectors shall be closed over and around all lacing ends and crimped without flattening. Connector prongs shall be crimped over and shall not protrude. In lieu of connectors, lacing ends may be secured with seamless cylindrical sleeves made of aluminum or zinc plated copper.

3.6 Identification marking. Prior to treatment for finishing, the letters "US", the contractors name, and the year of manufacture of the snowshoe shall be indented on the frame. The size and location of the markings shall be as shown on Drawing 2-10-99. The markings shall be legible after finishing.

3.7 Replacement of defective components. During the manufacturing process, components having material defects or damages that are classified as defects in 4.4.2.1, 4.4.2.2 or 4.4.3 shall be removed from production and replaced with non-defective and properly matched components.

3.8 Workmanship. The end items shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification. The finished snowshoe shall not be sprung, malformed, or bent out of shape, and shall have all sharp edges and burrs removed. The finish shall be dry, adherent, and uniform; and shall be free from runs, wrinkles, blisters, peeling or flaking, and areas of no film or thin film with primer or base metal showing through. Welds shall be sound and care shall be taken to eliminate weld flaws such as cracks, porosity, incomplete penetration, incomplete fusion, notches, and undercuts.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements (examinations and tests) as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in this specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to ensure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

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4.1.1 Responsibility for compliance. All items shall meet all requirements of sections 3 and 5. The inspection set forth in this specification shall become a part of the contractor's overall inspection system or quality program. The absence of any inspection requirements in the specification shall not relieve the contractor of the responsibility of ensuring that all products or supplies submitted to the Government for acceptance comply with all requirements of the contract. Sampling inspection, as part of manufacturing operations, is an acceptable practice to ascertain conformance to requirements, however, this does not authorize submission of known defective material, either indicated or actual, nor does it commit the Government to accept defective material.

4.1.2 Responsibility for dimensional requirements. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for ensuring that all specified dimensions have been met. When dimensions cannot be examined on the end item, inspection shall be made at any point, or at all points in the manufacturing process necessary to ensure compliance with all dimensional requirements.

4.1.3 Certificates of compliance. When certificates of compliance are submitted, the Government reserves the right to inspect such items to determine the validity of the certification.

4.2 Classification of inspections. The inspection requirements specified herein are classified as follows:

a. First article inspection (see 4.3).
b. Quality conformance inspection (see 4.4).

4.3 First article inspection. When a first article is required (see 3.1 and 6.2), it shall be examined for the defects specified in 4.4.3 and 4.4.4 and tested for the characteristics specified in 4.4.5.

4.4 Quality conformance inspection. Unless otherwise specified, sampling for inspection shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

4.4.1 Component and material inspection. In accordance with 4.1, components and materials shall be inspected in accordance with all the requirements of referenced documents unless otherwise excluded, amended, modified, or qualified in this specification or applicable purchase document.

4.4.1.1 Component and material certification. A certificate of compliance may be acceptable as evidence that the connectors and sleeves conform to the requirements specified on Drawing 2-10-106.

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4.4.2 In-process inspection. Inspection of subassemblies shall be made to ascertain that construction details which cannot be examined in the finished product are in accordance with specified requirements. The Government reserves the right to exclude from consideration for acceptance, any material or service for which in-process inspection has indicated nonconformance.

4.4.2.1 Operation examination. Examination shall be made of the operations listed below to determine compliance with the indicated requirements. Whenever nonconformance is noted, correction shall be made to affected items and process. Items that cannot be corrected shall be removed from production.

Operation	Requirement
Welding is accomplished with inert-gas metal arc (tungsten electrode)	Drawing 2-10-99
Stress relieving of completed welded assemblies	Drawing 2-10-99
Pretreatment process for prevention of corrosion	Drawing 2-10-99
Application of primer prior to enameling (when applicable) (when alternate polyester coating is used there is no primer)	Drawing 2-10-99
Identification marking before pretreatment	3.6

4.4.2.2 Welding examination. Prior to the pretreatment process, the snowshoes shall be examined for the defects listed in table I. The lot shall be expressed in units of snowshoes. The sample unit shall be one snowshoe. The inspection level shall be S-3 (see 6.5).

TABLE I. Welding visual examination

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Welds and welding	Weld missing	101	
	Weld not in specified location		201
	Weld is less than specified length	102	
	Weld not type specified	103	
	Evidence of burn through on frame	104	
	Undercut on cross bars or frame	105	
	Weld is incomplete, e.g., not continuous (all around) where required	106	
	Unsound, cracked, porous, fractured, or otherwise not fused	107	
	Slag inclusion, flash, or flux deposit not removed		202
	Not smooth or not uniform	108	

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4.4.3 End item visual examination. The end items shall be examined for the defects listed in table II. The lot size shall be expressed in units of snowshoes. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated snowshoe. The inspection level shall be II (see 6.5).

TABLE II. End item visual defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Finish	Not adherent, i.e., flaking, blistering, or peeling	101	
	Dirt or foreign matter imbedded		201
	Finish not dry, i.e., tacky to touch		202
	Color not white	102	
	Not a close match to specified color		203
	Scratch, scuff, dig or abrasion exposing bare metal		204
	Area of thin film, e.g., base metal shows through	103	
	Area of thin film, e.g., primer shows through		205
	Not smooth and not uniform, i.e., run, sag, drop, or wrinkle		206
	Area of no film	104	
Frame	Hole missing	105	
	Component missing	106	
	Hole not countersunk		207
	Hole not free from burrs or rough edges		208
	Gripping strip extends beyond contour of frame	107	
	Frame surface not free from sharp edges or burrs	108	
	Sprung, malformed, cracked, or bent out of shape	109	
	Cross bar not positioned as shown on drawing		209
	Tail end corners not broken all around		210
Lacing	Lacing not through each hole	110	
	Lacing end not secured with connector or sleeve	111	
	Lacing end extends more than 1/2 inch beyond connector or sleeve		211

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TABLE III. End item tests

Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test paragraph	No. determinations per sample unit	Results reported as
Toe and heel section:				
Deflection	3.4.1.1	4.5.1	2 (1 each at heel and toe section)	Deflection to nearest 1/16 inch
Permanent set	3.4.1.1	4.5.1	2 (1 each at heel and toe section)	Pass or fail
Center section:				
Deflection	3.4.1.2	4.5.1	1	Deflection to nearest 1/16 inch
Permanent set	3.4.1.2	4.5.1	1	Pass or fail

4.4.6 Packaging examination. The fully packaged end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of shipping containers. The sample unit shall be one shipping container fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-2 (see 6.5).

Examine	Defect
Marking (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application
Materials	Any component missing, damaged, or not as specified
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components, such as: incomplete sealing or closure of flap, improper taping, loose strapping, or inadequate stapling Bulged or distorted container Snowshoe not packed on edge Tail edge of showshoe not positioned in the direction specified

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Examine	Defect
Workmanship (cont'd)	Snowshoes not interleaved with kraft paper or more than four pieces of kraft paper used Snowshoe in contact with adjacent snowshoe
Content	Number of snowshoes per container is more or less than specified

4.4.7 Palletization examination. The fully packaged and palletized end items shall be examined for the defects listed below. The lot size shall be expressed in units of palletized unit loads. The sample unit shall be one palletized unit load, fully packaged. The inspection level shall be S-1 (see 6.5).

Examine	Defect
Finished dimensions	Length, width, or height exceeds specified maximum requirement
Palletization	Pallet pattern not as specified Interlocking of loads not as specified Load not bonded as specified
Weight	Exceeds maximum load limits
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; of improper size, location, sequence, or method of application

4.5 Methods of inspection.

4.5.1 Deflection and permanent set test.

4.5.1.1 Loading blocks. Low density wood loading blocks shall be used for this test. The loading block for testing the toe and heel sections shall be 3 inches by 2 inches by 1/2 inch. The loading block for the center section shall be 8 inches by 3 inches by 1/2 inch.

4.5.1.2 Positioning of toe section. The snowshoe shall be positioned (top side up) by elevating and supporting the tail so that the under surface of the loading block when placed on the toe section will be parallel to floor or test table. The snowshoe frame shall be rigidly supported at front and rear cross bars. The longitudinal center lines of the block and snowshoe shall be aligned and the 2-inch dimension edge of the block shall be positioned parallel to and not less than 1-1/2 inches from the leading edge of the front cross bar. The block shall not rest on the first cross lacing adjacent to the cross bar.

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4.5.1.3 Positioning of heel section. The snowshoe frame shall be positioned top side up with lacing parallel to floor or test table and shall be rigidly supported at tail and rear cross bar. The longitudinal center lines of the loading block and snowshoe shall be aligned and the 2-inch dimension edge of the block shall be positioned parallel to and not less than 1-1/2 inches from the trailing edge of the rear cross bar. The block shall not rest on the first cross lacing adjacent to the cross bar.

4.5.1.4 Positioning of center section. The snowshoe shall be placed in a horizontal position, rigidly supported at the front and rear cross bars. The longitudinal center lines of the loading block and snowshoe shall be aligned and the 3-inch dimension edge of the block shall be positioned parallel to and not less than 4-1/2 inches from trailing edge of the front cross bar. The block shall not rest on the first cross lacing adjacent to the front cross bar.

4.5.1.5 Procedure. The snowshoe and loading blocks shall be positioned as required for the section to be tested (see 4.5.1.2, 4.5.1.3 and 4.5.1.4). Three measurements shall be made for each section of the snowshoe. Each measurement shall be the perpendicular distance from the center of the bottom surface of the loading block to a fixed point on the test table or floor. The first measurement shall be made with no weight applied to the loading block. The second measurement shall be made 1 minute after a dead weight has been evenly distributed on top of the loading block. A 30-pound weight shall be used for the toe and heel sections and a 200-pound weight used for the center section. Immediately after the second measurement, remove the weight and make a third measurement. The difference between the first and second measurements of each section shall be recorded as the deflection of the section. The difference between the first and third measurement of each section shall be recorded as the permanent set of the section.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or Commercial as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A packing. Twelve pairs of snowshoes, shall be packed in a snug-fitting fiberboard shipping container conforming to style FOL, grade V2s of PPP-B-636. The shipping container shall be of a size palletizable in accordance with the appendix of MIL-STD-147. The snowshoes shall be packed on edge with the first twelve snowshoes positioned with the tail ends in one direction and the remaining twelve snowshoes positioned with the tail ends in the opposite direction. Snowshoes shall be interleaved with 60-pound minimum basis weight kraft paper in accordance with A-A-203 in such a manner as to prevent contact between adjacent snowshoes. Each shipping container shall be closed in accordance with method III, waterproofed in accordance with method V, and reinforced in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that

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the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.6. Shipping containers shall be arranged in unit loads in accordance with MIL-L-35078 for the type and class of load specified (see 6.2). Strapping shall be limited to nonmetallic strapping, except for type II class F loads.

5.1.2 Level B packing. Twelve pairs of snowshoes shall be packed as specified in 5.1.1, except that the fiberboard container shall be type CF (variety DW) or SF, class domestic, grade 275 of PPP-B-636. Arrangement of snowshoes and interleaving shall be as specified in 5.1.1. Closure shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix of PPP-B-636, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.6.

5.1.2.1 Weather-resistant fiberboard containers. When specified (see 6.2), the shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s, or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III as specified in the appendix thereto, except that the inspection shall be in accordance with 4.4.6.

5.1.3 Commercial packing. Snowshoes shall be packed in accordance with ASTM D 3951.

5.2 Palletization. When specified (see 6.2), snowshoes packed as specified in 5.1.2 or 5.1.3, shall be palletized on a 4-way entry pallet in accordance with load type Ia of MIL-STD-147. Pallet types shall be type I (4-way entry), type IV, or type V in accordance with MIL-STD-147. Pallets shall be fabricated from wood groups I, II, III, or IV of MIL-STD-731. Each prepared load shall be bonded with primary and secondary straps in accordance with bonding means C and D or film bonding means F or G. Pallet pattern shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-147.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or purchase order, shipping containers and palletized unit loads shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129 or ASTM D 3951, as applicable.

6. NOTES

(This section contains information of a general or explanatory nature that may be helpful, but is not mandatory.)

6.1 Intended use. The snowshoe is intended for use in traveling over snow and ice covered terrain. The snowshoe can be used on either foot.

6.2 Acquisition requirements. Acquisition documents must specify the following:

a. Title, number, and date of this specification.
b. Issue of DODISS to be cited in the solicitation, and if required, the specific issue of individual documents referenced (see 2.1.1 and 2.2).
c. When a first article is required (see 3.1, 4.3, and 6.3).

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d. Level of packing (see 5.1).
e. Type and class of unit load (see 5.1.1).
f. When weather-resistant grade fiberboard shipping containers are required for level B packing (see 5.1.2.1).
g. When palletization is required (see 5.2).
h. Acceptance criteria required (see 6.5).

6.3 First article. When a first article is required, it shall be inspected and approved under the appropriate provisions of FAR 52.209. The first article should be a preproduction sample. The contracting officer should specify the appropriate type of first article and the number of units to be furnished. The contracting officer should also include specific instructions in acquisition documents regarding arrangements for selection, inspection, and approval of the first article.

6.4 Sample. For access to samples, address the contracting activity issuing the invitation for bids or request for proposal.

6.5 Acceptance criteria. The acceptance criteria recommended below is furnished only for guidance to the procuring activity. The acceptance criteria as specified in the contract or purchase order shall be binding. Unless otherwise specified, the following acceptance criteria are in accordance with MIL-STD-105.

6.5.1 For welding examination. An acceptable quality level (AQL), expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 2.5 for major defects and 4.0 for minor defects is recommended.

6.5.2 For end item visual examination. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 1.5 for major defects and 2.5 for minor defects is recommended.

6.5.3 For end item dimensional examination. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 4.0 is recommended.

6.5.4 For end item testing. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 2.5 is recommended.

6.5.5 For packaging examination. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 2.5 is recommended.

6.5.6 For palletization examination. An AQL, expressed in terms of defects per hundred units, of 6.5 is recommended.

6.6 Supersession data. This specification supersedes MIL-S-43272Edated 13 August 1984.

6.7 Subject term (key word) listing.

Cold weather
Field equipment

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Custodians:

Army - GL
Navy - NU
Air Force - 99

Review activities:

Army - MD
Air Force - 82
DLA - CT

User activities:

Navy - MC
Air Force - 45

Preparing activity:

Army - GL

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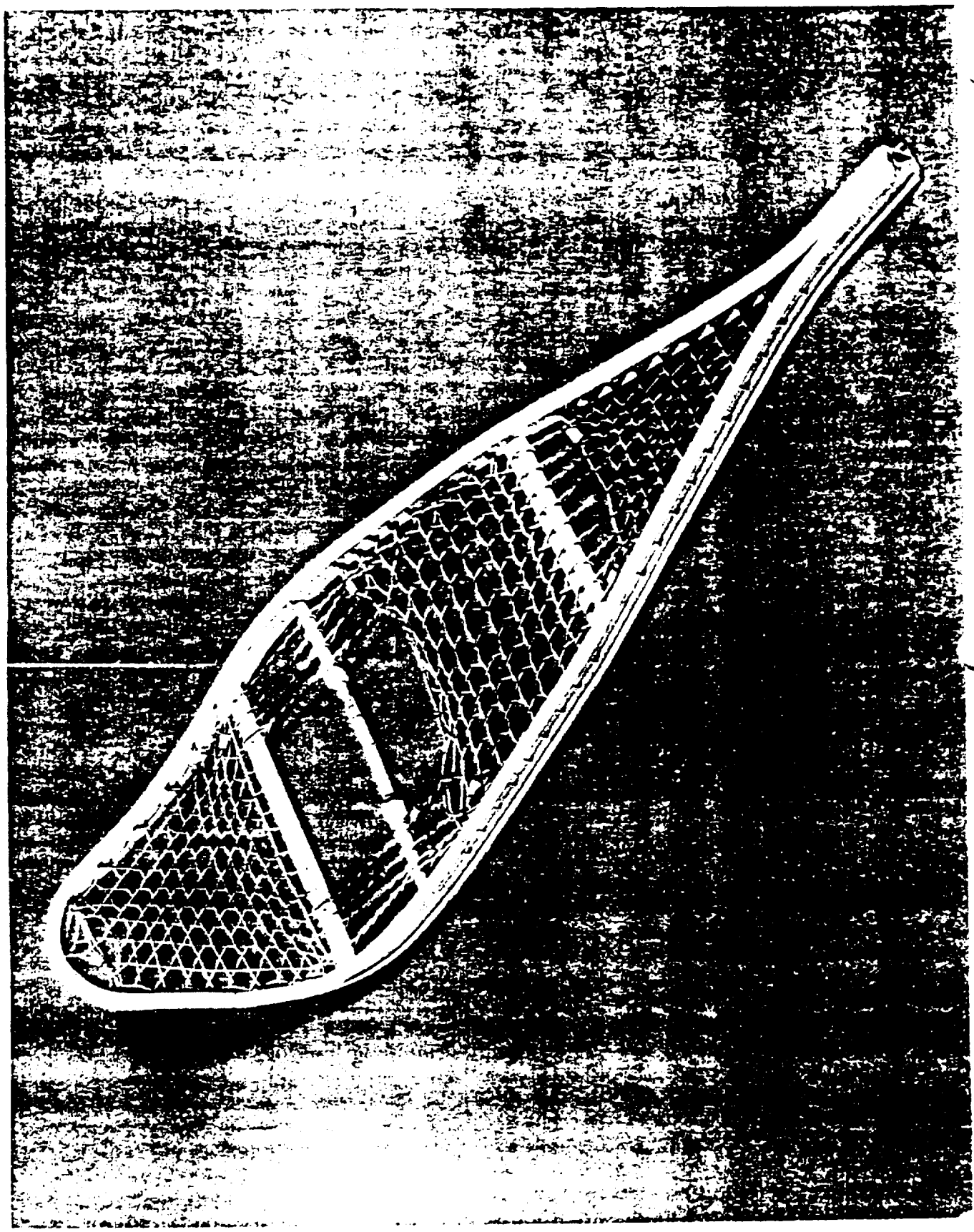


FIGURE 1 - SNOWSHOE, TRAIL, MAGNESIUM, SNOW AND ICE TRAVERSING EQUIPMENT (SITE)

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-S-44377	Snowshoe, Trail, Magnesium, Snow and Ice Traversing Equipment (Si

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE
MIL-S-44377	Snowshoe, Trail, Magnesium, Snow and Ice Traversing Equipment (S

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION

4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*

- ☐ VENDOR
- ☐ USER
- ☐ MANUFACTURER
- ☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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